MATI JERUSALEM

ReStart:HOPE - Reservist Business Community & Rehabilitation Program

Executive management receiving community leaders' reservist business owners at MATI to hear about their challenges and needs.

The war in Israel has devastated the small business sector, leaving reservist owners grappling with overwhelming challenges: 83% have suffered income losses and closures have doubled. The demanding 70-day annual service requirements further hinder their ability to rebuild. National assistance programs often fall short, failing to support reservists who must navigate applications during or immediately after service when mental capacity and availability are limited. Now that the war is over and many reservists have returned from the front lines, they urgently need comprehensive support to rebuild their livelihoods and lives.

To meet this need, MATI Jerusalem's **ReStart:Hope Reservist Business Community and Rehabilitation Program** provides a community-centered, three-pronged rehabilitation initiative for over 200 reservist business owners in Jerusalem and surrounding areas, built on a "reservists-for-reservists" model.

The program rests on three pillars:

A. **Community Building** – fostering a strong peer network through shared workspaces, community campaigns, corporate photography sessions, a dedicated hotline, and networking events and conferences.

- **4 networking events** for 48 reservists
- **8 meetup events** at reservist-owned venues for 200 reservists
- **2 professional headshot sessions** for 50 reservists
- **2 conferences** with meaningful content and networking opportunities for 200 reservists
- **A shared workspace** for 60 reservists

B. **Tailored Content** – offering flexible workshops, courses, and webinars on financial resilience, emotional adjustment, reservists' rights, AI tools, digital marketing, and more.

- **20 Hands-On Workshops** for 240 reservists
- **5 Evening Business Courses & Workshops** for 132 reservists
- **8 Webinars** for 320 reservists

C. **Business Support Packages** – providing first-aid business assistance via heavily subsidized consulting, business planning for loans and business automation packages.

- **Business Mentoring & Loan Application Support Package** for 200 reservists
- **Tailor-Made Business Automation Package** for 50 reservists

All services are delivered in priority by reservists for reservists and hosted at reservist-owned venues, ensuring peer support and creating economic opportunities within the reservist community. **ReStart:Hope** offers a practical, emotional, and economic lifeline for those who defended the front lines and now need to rebuild.

For more information, please contact Malkah Rothberg at malkah@mati.org.il

A.S, MATI's new Program Community Manager, is a single dad of a 5-year-old and served 600 days as a militia intel officer over the past two years. As a community leader and eco-therapist for PTSD, he is deeply committed to soldiers' mental wellbeing in Gaza. "Mati doesn't just save businesses—it saves lives. MATI sat with us, genuinely listened to our pains, and were ready to provide the support needed in the field."

A B., a tour guide, has been supported by MATI since 2022 with mentoring, workshops, and business automation. A former paratrooper officer who served 350+ days in Syria and Lebanon, he now lives with PTSD while working to restart his business.

TK is a new immigrant and owner of the digital marketing business "Bite-Sized Media". Her husband was called up for reserve duty, leaving T. to manage both her business and family alone. When work demands increased, T. was uncertain how to financially navigate and scale her business. She has now received 25 hours of MATI mentoring and enthusiastically recommends MATI to her husband and everyone she knows!